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M1. Overview

Five Essential Points for Agents

- Education agents can significantly influence the lives of international students and the success of French institutions and schools. With this influence comes responsibility. Agents must act professionally and ethically to reinforce the role of agents as valuable within the international education sector.
- As much as it is the responsibility of agents to promote the education institutions they represent, there are limits to this promotion: agents must always be truthful in their discussions with students about the features of an institution and not mislead them or overpromise.
- It is the agent's job to match the international student with an appropriate institution and course of study; the agent should not persuade a student to attend a school or choose a course if it does not suit the student's interests and credentials.
- Agents are expected to stay up to date on factors which may affect their current and prospective students who are choosing to come to France, including changes in immigration policies and services and opportunities available to students.
- The two basics in terms of agents making good matches between students and institutions are (1) listen to students and really consider their needs and goals/objectives and (2) be fully knowledgeable about an institution's programmes, policies, and advantages.

Education agents representing French institutions play a very important role in a number of ways:

- They are representing one of the leading—and increasingly popular—study abroad destinations in the world and they have the opportunity

to match international students to the French institutions or schools which best match their needs.

- They are contributing to the internationalisation and diversity of French education.
- They are furthering knowledge and culture exchange between countries, which promotes economic and intellectual progress and greater understanding between peoples of different ethnicities, religions, and world views.
- They have the power to affect both the reputation and revenues of French education institutions and the lives and career paths of individuals going to study in France.

With this influence comes responsibility. Agents who do not accept the responsibility of their key role (e.g., by providing bad advice or acting unethically) can seriously undermine the reputation of French education — as well as the lives and dreams of the students they counsel.

By contrast, education agents who commit seriously to the high standards their profession demands can expect fulfilling, lucrative careers and strong relationships with the education institutions and students who trust them.

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